

A person is standing on a rocky peak, looking out over a vast landscape. In the background, there is a large body of water, possibly a lake or a wide river, surrounded by rugged mountains. The sky is filled with soft, white clouds. The overall scene is serene and majestic, suggesting a sense of accomplishment and a new perspective.

REBOOT CAMP

Bill McGlone

10 LIFE-ALTERING STEPS TO TAKE YOU FROM SURVIVING TO THRIVING AFTER 40

INSIDE

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A QUICK NOTE FROM ME

Hi, friend. I appreciate you taking time out of your life to give this a read. There are a lot of forces fighting for your attention, so I'm grateful that you decided to lend some of it here. To repay your gesture of good faith, I promise to make the best use of your time.

My goal is to provide you with clear, actionable and attainable steps to help you not only successfully recover from a mid-life setback, but to build a life of prosperity and purpose in its wake.

To help accomplish this, I have distilled decades of hard-earned wisdom into 10 steps that, if followed, will change your life.

But before we jump into the lessons below— and perhaps save you some time— I want to be 100% transparent about what this guide is **not** intended to teach you.

It will not teach you tricks on how to get laid more.

However, if followed, this guide can instill in you the self-confidence and charisma that people find extremely attractive. A self-confident man doesn't need to rely on tricks.

It will not teach you hacks on how to get rich quick.

However, if followed, this guide can help you build yourself into a presence that money and financial opportunities gravitate toward.

So, save the tricks and hacks for the amateurs and small-timers. When we're done here, you will be on the path to attaining the attitude, confidence and winning characteristics that most men only pretend to possess.

In short, you will not be drawn to success. Success will be drawn to you.

To get the most out of this guide, I'd ask you to take the axiom of 'I'll believe it when I see it' and flip it on its head. When you put your full belief into these steps and carry them out to the fullest of your potential, a whole new world will appear in front of you.

My suggestion is to give this your all for the next 90 days and watch how much your life expands. The 90 days are going to pass anyhow, right? Wouldn't you want to make them count?

Whether you are reading this from your swank condo, shitty apartment or friend's couch, these steps, when followed, can expand your life in ways you didn't think were possible.

It will cost you nothing, yet it could change everything.

With gratitude,
— Bill

STEP ONE

OWN IT

"You must take personal responsibility. You cannot change the circumstances, the seasons, or the wind, but you can change yourself. That is something you have charge of."

— JIM ROHN

You cannot take one step on your new path until you accept complete and total ownership for the situation you currently find yourself in. Repeat these words until they are internalized. And then repeat them some more.

I am 100% responsible for my life's circumstances: past, present and future.

To some, this might be a bitter pill to swallow. If it helps, think of this as the price of admission. A prerequisite to enroll in all future courses.

Your wife said that you're not the same person she married? Own it.

Your boss passed you up for promotion again? Own it.

Your financial situation is all sorts of fucked up? Own. It.

Until you accept responsibility for your current reality, you will remain stuck exactly where you are: blaming others for your circumstances and not taking any actions to improve them.

The ensuing steps will serve as the pillars that will elevate your life to new heights. This first step forms the foundation for all those pillars to rest on.

Blaming others for your misfortunes, while temporarily gratifying, will drain you of your power and self-respect. Sure, it might feel good in the moment, but it subconsciously makes you lose your agency and feel inadequate and undeserving of a better life.

While you have no control over what your boss does or what your ex says or how your stock portfolio is performing, you have absolute power over how you respond to those challenges.

"Between stimulus and response there is a space. In that space is our power to choose our response. In our response lies our growth and our freedom."

— VIKTOR FRANKL, *MAN'S SEARCH FOR MEANING*

So, whether your marriage is in shambles, your career is in the shitter or your local building department is finalizing paperwork to condemn your body out of public safety concerns, own it. By doing so, you will have given yourself a transformative gift.

In that moment, you will have given yourself your life back.

Once you own your current circumstances, you become a different person. You make different choices. You see the world from a new perspective. You no longer need to hide behind excuses or blame others for any shortcoming in your life.

THIS IS THE SKELETON KEY THAT WILL UNLOCK ALL LIFE'S OTHER DOORS FOR YOU.

Another reason why you need to take, as Jocko Willink would say, extreme ownership of your life is because nobody is coming to save you. I know it sounds bleak, but most people don't really care about your problems.

I'm sure they feel bad for you on occasion, but they're too worried about their own shit to really be invested in fixing yours. That's just how we humans are.

This is not even accounting for the people who actually take personal joy in your hardships. We both know they're out there, right? Hell, some of them might be 'friends' that you're currently confiding in.

Your one-word response to this situation? The same word Jocko would use.

Good.

Nobody really cares that I'm struggling right now?

Good, it will only be more gratifying when I build this great life on my own.

Some people are actually happy to see me down?

Good, hope they enjoy using me to feel better about their own small lives. I'll be sure to wave to them as I roll past.

I know that this might sound like a dark worldview to have. I don't mean to say that there aren't people that love you and are rooting for your success. I'm sure you have some good people in your corner. But, you are the one that needs to lace up the gloves and get in the ring to fight for the life that you want. The life you deserve.

ACHIEVING GREATNESS IS A SINGLE-PLAYER GAME. ONLY THE INDIVIDUAL TRANSCENDS.

THE ACTION

Write this down on an index card and tape it to your bathroom mirror or someplace where you will see it every morning: "This is my one and only life, which I own fully. And I will live fully." Read it out loud. Mean it.



STEP TWO

DON'T LOOK BACK

"Stop being a prisoner of your past. Become the architect of your future."

— ROBIN SHARMA

Author Robert Crais's popular LA detective novel series features a hard-nosed character named Joe Pike. In addition to his aviator glasses that the gruff Vietnam vet never seems to take off, Pike's other unique physical trait is the red arrows tattooed on each of his deltoids. They serve as a reminder of the direction in which he always moves.

Forward.

You, my friend, are now Joe Pike. Every time that you start dwelling on the past, I want you to stop and visualize that you have those arrows on each shoulder and adjust your direction accordingly.

Too often, our present opportunities get swallowed up by the destructive habit of living in the past. Instead of making the best of the here and now, we waste our time sifting through the ashes of the over and done.

All time that has preceded this moment is, in essence, dead time. It has ceased. Expired. There is no more life force available there for you to tap into and draw energy from. Instead, by lingering there, it steals power away from the only place that matters.

THE PRESENT.

You wouldn't perform CPR on a rotting corpse. Don't waste your time and resources on something you can't bring back to life.

Another trap that some of us fall into is an obsession to rewrite the past by mixing fact with fiction. Depending on your current emotional state, you might use artistic license to downplay a really horrible past experience or overdramatize some relatively benign memory.

Come to terms with the good, bad and ugly of your past, including the part you played in it. If you hold some regret over some things you did or said, join the club. We've all fallen short of who we hoped to be at one time or another. All you can do is vow to do better and then honor that vow in the only place you can. The present.

Stop reliving and revising your past. As the first sentence of the Serenity Prayer instructs, "accept the things you can't change." This very moment is the only place where change can happen.

The last point I want to stress about the perils of time travel is that you should never, under any circumstance, get back with your ex. Maybe you think that's a harsh statement or I'm just being a jaded prick. While you may be right on both accounts, it doesn't make the statement wrong.

In one of Stephen King's greatest novels, *Pet Sematary*, the main character becomes overcome with grief when his young son is tragically killed. In a desperate attempt to bring him back, he takes the boy's body to an ancient burial ground that has the dark power to resurrect its inhabitants.

To the father's elation, it works. His son returns to him. Except... he is not the same person anymore. He might look the same, but inside he is soulless and vengeful.

When you are dealing with the end of a long-term relationship, there will be days (perhaps months) of oscillating remorse, anger and self-bargaining. During these waves, the desire to reconcile might seem like a really good idea.

It isn't.

"Sometimes, dead is better."

Cool?

Cool.

So, we have taken personal ownership and established the one direction in which we are moving. Are you feeling ready to start building this new, epic life of yours? If you're not, it doesn't matter. Start anyway.

THE ACTION

Purchase an old-school planner or a wall-mounted, dry-erase calendar. Next, choose an activity associated with each of the following categories: body, mind, human connection. For example, a trio of activities that ladder up could be: exercise (of any form), reading five pages of a book, starting a conversation with a stranger. Whatever that looks like for you, it looks like that for you.

Now here's where the magic happens. For each day that you successfully complete your activity in each category, put a big 'X' in the box. Your goal is to be able to add another 'X' to the chain at the end of each day. Challenge yourself to never break the chain!

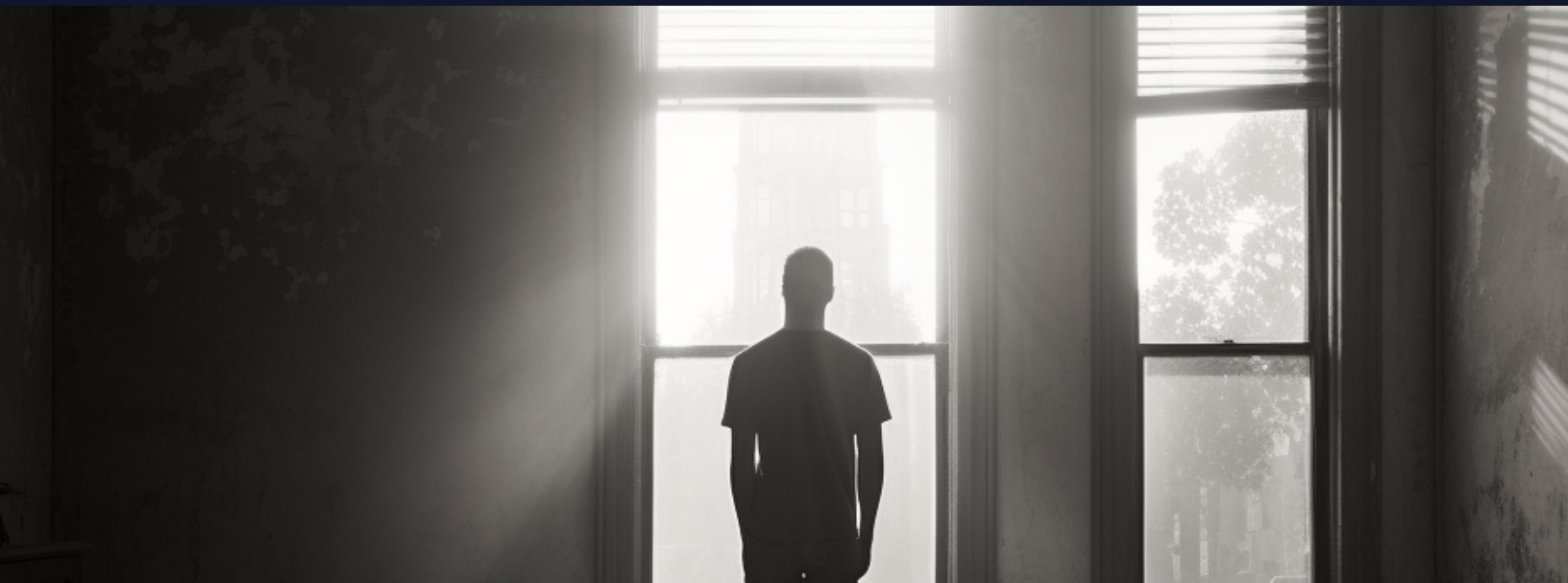
And guess what? If you follow the ensuing steps, you are virtually guaranteed to keep the chain alive. As someone who practices this discipline, there is nothing more gratifying than seeing an entire month of unbroken 'X's.

STEP THREE

START NOW

"Whatever you can do or dream you can, begin it. Boldness has genius, power and magic in it. Begin it now!"

— GOETHE



THE MOMENT BEFORE YOU BEGIN. SOURCE: MIDJOURNEY

When my marriage was finally taken off life support and I relocated to some shitty apartment on the seedy side of town (bodegas, dive bars and laundromats, oh my!), I just wanted to sit on my thrift-store couch, stare at my donated TV and drink my oversized bottle of cheap red wine.

Intellectually, I knew that this was the worst thing I could do to myself and my fragile mental state. Emotionally, I didn't give a fuck. I was sitting on a used couch of unknown origin in a room that cops have definitely dusted for prints at some point, for chrissakes!

Was I expected to solve world hunger at this juncture?

For those first couple months holed up in that apartment, I would tell myself that I needed to get my shit together, but I wasn't ready yet. That I needed some more time to pass. That I'd start when I felt healed or happier or hopeful.

Eventually, I realized that the day I felt ready to rebuild was never going to arrive. I just needed to start and hope that the healing, motivation and positivity would eventually show up at the door (that's if they didn't get carjacked driving through my neighborhood).

As a writer, waiting for inspiration to appear and help guide my fingers over the keyboard is a surefire strategy to never finish a sentence. My success is the result of showing up even when I don't want to (ESPECIALLY when I don't want to) and getting to work. Once I start, the reinforcements of inspiration, confidence and fulfillment come rushing to my aid.

Don't wait. Just start. The rest will take care of itself.

Another huge benefit to starting is that it is the best non-prescription cure for anxiety that exists. Thinking about all the shit that needs fixing can be crippling.

Did you ever get yourself so overwhelmed about all the things that you need to do that you wind up doing nothing? Anxiety gets its nourishment from the thoughts you feed it. It feasts off of your inaction.

You want to conquer anxiety? Start starting. Take action and anxiety will starve itself to death.

Can we all agree that the best time to begin your Act 2 is right now? Perfect.

So, you're probably wondering 'where do I start?' Great question. I love the energy! A little stressful for me, but it's cool. I can totally work with it.

Start by making your bed in the morning.

Some of you are probably wondering if your mom told me to write that, but hear me out. At the start of your path toward greatness, your goal is to get wins on the board. Early and often. An epic life is not created by grand gestures and superhuman feats. It's created by the compound interest of small, seemingly inconsequential acts done consistently over a long period of time.

You are building this new world for yourself brick by brick. It might seem like a mundane, painfully slow process at times, but before you know it, you will step back and see the dream world you always wished you could create taking shape.

Think of it like a great relationship. A romance for the ages is not made by showy proclamations or lavish gifts. It's created by daily micro-expressions of love: listening with full presence as she recounts her tough day, gently guiding her to the inside of you as you saunter down the sidewalk, apologizing when you've fallen short and meaning it.

Like a great relationship, a great life doesn't just happen. They can't be bought or arrive pre-fabricated and fully formed. They are made through continuous effort.

Brick by brick.

Start small, but start.

THE ACTION

When your alarm goes off tomorrow morning, get up immediately and make your bed.

Congratulations. You recorded your first win of the day before you even brushed your teeth.

STEP FOUR

STRIP DOWN

"One does not accumulate but eliminate. It is not daily increase but daily decrease. The height of cultivation always runs to simplicity."

— BRUCE LEE



PHOTO BY VITALY TARANOV ON UNSPLASH

Fun fact: my mother was a hoarder!

When I was very young, her condition was relatively benign. Closets were cluttered, but the rest of the house remained relatively unscathed. As I got older, the clutter started to spill out into the living areas.

She wanted to keep her shame private which, as it turns out, is the only place shame can survive.

Fast-forward to the summer of 2022. After my dad passed away and with my mother no longer able to care for herself, we decided it was time to sell the house. At this point, 90% of that four-bedroom ranch was overtaken by her stuff. Narrow pathways were carved out amid sagging boxes and overstuffed plastic bags, allowing narrow access from the front door to the kitchen, bathroom and master bedroom.

19

MOVERS

16

HOURS

15

GARBAGE TRUCK TRIPS

I realize this is an extreme example. My mom's childhood poverty caused an unhealthy obsession with collecting material things. The point I'm trying to make is that all that stuff she treasured didn't prevent her from losing her husband, her home or her mental faculties.

At the end, the things that she thought would fill the hole inside her all got carted off to fill a hole on the outskirts of town.

Though not as extreme, don't we all assign a level of attachment and identity to our material possessions? Aren't our homes, cars and wine collections just extensions of how we want the world to see us?

Our assets become our ambassadors.

I was no different. I thought my stuff was a representation of how cool/affluent/artistic I was. I had a strong attachment to the things that, I thought, conveyed status.

That was until I lost them all.

Divorce reduced me down to the bare essentials. Even if I could afford to buy myself anything lavish, the places I was living early on didn't have a lot of space for stuff.

To be fair, my first apartment did have a walk-in closet. However, I was using it as a bedroom for my youngest son.

Good times!

I have spent the majority of my career working in digital marketing, specifically in web development. Whenever there was some data point that showed a decrease in consumer engagement (aka: people aren't buying enough of our shit), we would be asked to redesign the website. Add more buttons! Use a bigger font! More images of beautiful people using our products!

Instead of introducing more complexity, I would often suggest that we do the opposite: reduce. Before throwing every idea at the page and seeing what sticks, first ask: 'what is the one action I want my customer to take?' Focus on that and remove all the other noise.

What is the one action you need to take? What is getting in the way of you taking that action? If something isn't serving that purpose, it needs to go.

You would do best to travel light during this transformative period. With less baggage to lug around, you will get to where you need to be much quicker. That includes all aspects of your life: physical, emotional and spiritual. Now is the perfect time to take inventory and remove the things that no longer serve you.

Strip it down to the studs and build anew.

THE ACTION

This week, clean out your closet and donate any piece of clothing you have not worn in the last year. You'd be surprised at how much space is taken up by nonsense.

STEP FIVE

GET OFF THE GRID

"Our society is much more interested in information than wonder, in noise rather than silence. And I feel that we need a lot more wonder and a lot more silence in our lives."

— FRED ROGERS

It's time to make yourself scarce. Building something as truly inspired as a great life takes deep, focused work. Like sunlight through a magnifying glass, you must harness all your energy and direct it toward the advancement of your goal.

It's been estimated that the average human is bombarded with more stimuli in one week than our 16th century ancestors were exposed to in their entire lifetime. Tweets, posts, texts, screens of all sizes — we live in a society overfed with information, yet starved of any true meaning.

This is the fate of the average human. Luckily for you, my friend, there is nothing average about you.

There is no longer room in your life for excess social media, gaming, porn or toxic people.

I recall sitting in my crappy apartment (I eventually moved from the petri dish couch to the kitchen table I got from my parents garage) scrolling through Facebook and feeling like utter shit.

Looking at all the happy families with their matching outfits on their fancy tropical vacations while I just watched a homeless dude take a dump in the empty lot next door was a jarring juxtaposition.

There is no upside to consuming someone else's greatest hits album, especially when you are just starting to pen your new lyrics. That's all that stuff is: someone trying desperately to show the world, and themselves, that they matter. They are a self-imprisoned hostage holding up today's newspaper and a camera to confirm proof of life.

Don't take the clickbait. You are all about creating a life worth documenting. Let them post. You just do.

In addition to virtual distraction, this is also the time for you to be ruthless in weeding out the relationships in your life that no longer serve you. The net negatives.

As Jim Rohn warned: "You are the average of the five people you spend the most time with." You need to choose wisely, especially during this stage of massive change.

Sometimes, it's intoxicating to trade sob stories with another 'victim.' To rail on about your heartless ex or prick boss. It feels good when your buddy nods his head in agreement and tells you how none of it is your fault. Remember Step 1. Your life is your life, not a timeshare. Own it in full.

Sometimes, we outgrow some of our friends. And that's not just okay — it's normal. You have friends for a reason, a season or a lifetime. Now is a good time to evaluate which of those buckets yours fit in. And why.

Spend your social time with people that fire you up, not wear you down. The optimistic, hopeful seekers who are excited for what tomorrow brings. Not the hapless naysayers who want to relive yesterday over and over again (see Step 2).

This is your time to go after greatness and make it yours. Don't let the siren song of push notifications or pity parties send you crashing into the rocks.

THE ACTION

Starting this Sunday, embark on a 30-day social media cleanse. Delete all apps from your phone. No posting, liking or doomscrolling for a month. Replace that time with reading or journaling or walking in nature.

Note: This would definitely merit an 'X' for the mind category (see Step 2).

STEP SIX

STRIVE FOR 'F#\$K YOU' SHAPE

"If you want something you've never had, you must be willing to do something you've never done."

— THOMAS JEFFERSON



SOURCE: MIDJOURNEY

We all would love to one day attain 'f#\$k you' money — that level of wealth where you no longer have to take shit from anyone. Where you get to decide how you spend your time and with whom you spend it.

While we all strive for financial prosperity and romantic bliss, there is another goal that is just as impactful to our quality of life.

That goal is getting in 'f#\$k you' shape.

I have no idea what kind of physical condition you currently find yourself in. But if you are anything like me when I first became single, you might be carrying around a few extra LBs.

Who am I kidding?!? I looked like a loaf of white bread that was left out in the rain, all swollen and pasty.

I think we can agree that everyone can benefit from improving their physical condition. While this might seem like a step taken to inflate your ego (it will) or get you laid more (it will), there are several other huge benefits:

- It will greatly increase your self-confidence, which is, perhaps, the most attractive quality you can possess.
- It will not only make you look younger, but you'll feel younger and more virile.
- It will signal to the world that you are a disciplined, high-value person, which will draw other high-value people into your orbit.
- Your energy and motivation will skyrocket.

So why do I call this 'f#\$k you' shape? Because when I was grinding it out to get in the best shape of my life and needed a little extra motivation, my self-talk went something like this:

Think I'm too old to get ripped? F#\$k you. Think I'm destined to always be average? F#\$k you.

I was turning perceived slights into fuel. I was on a mission to prove everyone wrong, especially the former version of me that used every excuse under the sun to stay fat and lazy.

Among the goals that you can choose to pursue, getting in shape will give you the highest return on investment across every aspect of your life.

SO — HOW DO YOU GET THERE?

Your diet is everything. As the saying goes, abs are made in the kitchen. Good nutrition is not half the battle. It IS the battle. If you are overweight, you need to be in a caloric deficit to shed fat. Full stop. You can't outrain a bad diet. Pick a nutrition protocol — keto, intermittent fasting, Whole30 — and go all in.

Consistency is king. To achieve your fitness goals, you need to eat healthy and train with the consistency of a metronome. Greatness will not show up unless you do.

A BURNING DESIRE + CONSISTENCY × TIME = GREATNESS

Lift heavy things. If you want to make a demonstrable impact on your physique, you need to prioritize weight training. A few dumbbells, a pull-up bar and some bodyweight exercises can yield massive results.

Walk every day. A 45 minute walk each day is the secret, no-cost weapon to help build the body you dream about. It burns a few hundred extra calories per day without taxing your central nervous system. It also helps you sort through all that mental clutter swirling in your head. Do it every day.

There are a bunch of things going on in your world right now that you have no control over. However, getting in the best shape of your life? That is 100% in your control. And it is 100% attainable.

THE ACTION

Go for a 30-minute walk today. No phone calls. No podcasts. Just walk and think. Do it again tomorrow. Then the day after. Over time, you should incorporate some type of resistance training. But this is where it starts.

STEP SEVEN

SCARE YOURSELF ON THE REGULAR

"Life shrinks or expands in proportion to one's courage."

— ANAÏS NIN

We humans are hardwired to be risk averse. The fear of losing something has more emotional potency than its comparable gain. Just take a look at the stock market — it experiences a downturn and thousands of people pull their money out, even though, historically, a boon always follows a bust.

A few all-too-common examples:

- As we dream about starting that business or pursuing our creative aspirations, we stand pat at our safe, uninspired jobs. Until they fire us. Or we die.
- We so badly want to go talk to that beautiful woman sitting alone at the bar but if she rejects us, we'll feel like a loser.
- We sense a rift with a person we really care about, but we're too afraid to have an uncomfortable ten-minute conversation to address it. Instead, we stay quiet and the relationship withers away.

Do any of these examples resonate with you? They certainly do with me.

In my younger days, I was all about playing it safe. I cared more about not looking stupid than I did about feeling fulfilled. As a result, I lived a very uninspired existence.

MEDIOCRITY IS FEAR DRESSED IN SWEATPANTS.

As often said (but rarely acted upon), your best life exists just outside of your comfort zone. Take a little inventory of your life's biggest accomplishments and I can guarantee that an uncomfortable leap into the unknown preceded it.

That sports glory you still relive all these years later wouldn't have happened if you weren't brave enough to suck at it at first.

That one romance that you use to measure all future romances wouldn't have happened if you didn't have the balls to go talk to her.

That weird, chubby kid that you always stuck up for in grade school would have gotten his ass kicked if you were too worried about being ostracized. By the way, thanks again for looking out for me.

Playing it safe is a habit. And the older, and more set in our ways we get, the harder it can be to break.

Instead of trying to remove it from our operating system, the best way to break a bad habit is to form a positive one to overwrite it. When I quit smoking fifteen years ago, I became a much more serious runner. I set distance goals for myself: first a 5K, then a 10K and finally, a half-marathon. Soon, I self-identified as a runner, not a smoker. And I never looked back.

You need to make living outside your comfort zone your new normal. You need to scare yourself daily.

When I came to terms with the fact that my life choices were not going to get me where I wanted to go, I decided to get uncomfortable. In what way?

- I pushed myself to start one conversation with a stranger every day.
- I took dancing lessons.
- I applied to, and won, a job that I felt I was underqualified for.
- I went to bars, parties and weddings by myself.
- I wrote and shared things publicly about my personal challenges that I would, in a former life, never feel comfortable sharing.

These were not reckless, over-the-top activities. That said, for an introvert whose default mode is to stay home, close the blinds and read, some of these challenges were downright terrifying.

But I summoned the courage. I felt the fear and did it anyway. And that, my friend, has made all the difference in the world.

Not only did putting myself out there open up a whole world of opportunity, it rewired my entire self-image. No longer did I identify as the guy that stays inside and plays it safe. I was now the guy that walks through any door and knows that he can handle whatever is on the other side of it.

There is real power in that. Get comfortable with discomfort. It will change your life.

THE ACTION

This week, do one thing that makes you uncomfortable. Start one conversation. Go somewhere alone. Apply for the thing you think you're underqualified for. Feel the fear. Do it anyway.

STEP EIGHT

EMOTIONS: BE A MASTER, NOT A SLAVE

"Holding on to anger is like grasping a hot coal with the intent of throwing it at someone else; you are the one who gets burned."

— BUDDHA

When I went through my divorce, I was angry all the time. Actually, that's not entirely true. I also set aside some time to be sad, scared, jealous and judgmental. Of course, having to accommodate all of these emotions was beyond a full-time job.

So, to give all of my negative feelings ample airtime, I kind of gave up sleeping. This, of course, would cause me to be even more emotional. On and on the cycle went.

Let me tell you, I was a real fucking life of the party back then.

We all know people that have held onto some emotional baggage for so long that it winds up defining them. They are small, bitter dudes that nobody wants to be around. You might not see them for years and then, within five minutes of catching up, he'll yet again bring up the bitch ex-wife that cleaned him out or the asshole boss that fired him or the telephone pole that made him spill beer all over his front seat.

I was slowly becoming that guy. I was bitter and spiteful toward my ex. I was short-tempered with my kids. I was always complaining to my friends. Fortunately, I came to the realization that my unchecked emotions were leading to my undoing before there was any irreparable damage.

At some point, whether we feel it justified or not, we have to let that shit go. Until then, we are attached to our past perceived injustices like an anchor, unable to ever move on.

Beyond its corrosive effect on existing relationships, anger is extremely unattractive. Nobody wants to be involved with someone who is negative, bitter and combative all the time.

If you want to spend your life pissed off all the time, be prepared to spend it alone.

ANGER ISN'T MANLY. IT CERTAINLY ISN'T 'ALPHA,' WHATEVER THAT IS.

ANGER IS FEAR DRESSED IN COMBAT GEAR.

The German philosopher Friedrich Nietzsche coined the term 'amor fati' to describe a key to a great life. Its translation: a love of fate. To achieve greatness, you shouldn't just try to endure the not-so-great aspects of your life. You should love them.

That one wants nothing to be different, not forward, not backwards, not in all eternity. Not merely bear what is necessary, still less conceal it...but love it.

You might be asking yourself, 'why is this dude wasting my time quoting some long-dead, boring German philosophizer? I liked him better when he was making fun of himself.'

First off, I hear you, and I promise no more German philosophy from this point on.

Secondly, if you were paying attention, **YOU SHOULD LOVE THIS PART, TOO.**

If asked to distill the best approach to a successful life into one sentence, it would simply be this: **Don't complain, don't explain.**

A man who is properly handling his business, does just that. He doesn't bitch about all the bad stuff that happened to him. And he doesn't feel the need to justify or rehash why he did what he did. He decides. He acts.

He handles his shit.

Don't complain, don't explain. He decides. He acts. He handles his shit.

If you are currently letting your emotions get the better of you, here are some tools that helped me:

- Daily exercise
- Getting outside for a walk
- Reading something mind-expanding
- Meditation
- Journaling
- Prioritizing sleep

THE ACTION

Fix your sleep! For the next 30 days, aim for at least seven hours of quality sleep at night.

Here are a few tips to help you accomplish this:

- Be consistent with your bedtime
- No food for at least two hours before bed
- No screens for at least one hour before bed
- Don't use alcohol to 'drink yourself to sleep'

STEP NINE

BE GRATEFUL

"Reflect upon your present blessings, of which every man has plenty; not on your past misfortunes, of which all men have some."

— CHARLES DICKENS



SOURCE: MIDJOURNEY

Considering how difficult your life might feel right now, it might seem unfathomable to be grateful for anything. I thought that, too.

Until I took a closer look.

When I was at my low point, a 40-year old man having to move back with his parents and sleep in his sister's old bedroom, I felt like the most beaten down, unfortunate person on the planet.

Since I had no money to do anything and a whole bunch of time to myself, I began a daily journal practice. My goal was to find three things to be grateful for and write them down. Many days, I was challenged to come up with three, so I would reduce it to one. As I pushed myself to see past my material shortcomings and take personal inventory of my life, I found much to be grateful for.

I was healthy. I had a roof over my head. I had kids that loved me. I had a family that supported me. I never went to bed cold or hungry. I could read and write.

Hell, on those days that I couldn't muster the energy to find something to be grateful for, I would simply write 'I am alive' over and over, until the page filled up.

I took these blessings for granted. I bet most of us do. But once I brought them out from the shadows and onto the page, I felt something shift. Instead of misfortune, I felt love. Instead of dread, I felt hope.

Since then, I have kept a daily practice of journaling about the things for which I am grateful. It sets me up for a successful day because it flips the switch in my mind from entitlement to appreciation.

That mental shift in perspective is like stepping out of the drab, flat, black and white surroundings of Kansas into the vibrant, boundless, technicolor world of Oz.

This might sound hard to believe, but one day — and sooner than you think — you will be grateful for the challenges you are currently facing (remember *amor fati*!). If we never experience true adversity in this life, we tend to take it all for granted. When life feels cruel and unrelenting, gratitude is our salvation.

THE ACTION

For the next 30 days, before you sleep, write down three things you're grateful for. If you can't find three, write one. If you can't find one, write "I am alive" until the page is full.

STEP TEN

HELP OTHERS

"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others."

— GANDHI

While this may sound counterintuitive, one of the best ways I dealt with my hardships was by helping other people with theirs. Like much of the other advice in this book, it sounds like the last thing you can imagine doing right now.

To achieve a life so successful that it defies logic, you must be willing to sometimes embrace the illogical.

If you look a little closer at it, the concept of helping others during a personal low point makes sense. For one thing, it takes you out of your own head. Instead of spending hours thinking about all of your issues, you are shifting focus to helping other people with their problems.

Think about it: it's really hard to help others and worry about your own shit at the same time.

Helping others feels good. Studies show that we feel more joy in helping others than we do by being on the receiving end of it. When we are able to provide even temporary comfort or happiness to another person, we, in turn, feel joy.

In addition, volunteering your time to a cause gives you an opportunity to meet other well-intentioned people. When I was going through my stuff, I decided to volunteer at a local ambulance squad. I learned new skills, made new friends and added purpose at a time in my life when I needed as much of it as I could get.

Riding in the back of the ambulance with terrified parents trying to console their sick child, or the weary children of an elderly parent who might be taking their last ride together, fundamentally changed me. It made me more empathetic.

It reminded me that everything can fall apart in an instant. And reinforced that delaying work on the things that I knew needed fixing was the worst strategy to have.

Instead of sitting at a bar and lamenting all of my life's hardships, I was actively helping others get through theirs.

Volunteer at your local ambulance squad or firehouse or hospice. Join the Special Olympics as a coach. Work at a food pantry. Spearhead a community clothing drive.

The good that you put out into the world will often come back to you tenfold. There really is no downside here.

THE ACTION

Find one thing you can do this week to help someone else. It doesn't have to be big. Call or text someone who's going through a tough time. Bring your elderly neighbor's garbage cans in for them. Take note of how good and unburdened you feel.

So, there you have it, my friend. The ten steps that will lead you down the path toward your life's best years. Follow them and there will be no stopping you.

Give it your all over the next 90 days and watch how much your life expands. The 90 days are going to pass anyhow.

Make them count.

Over that time, there will be uncomfortable moments when you'll want to retreat to your old, safe way of living. Resist it. Sit with the discomfort and you will soon feel it pass through you.

Your whole new life awaits you on the other side of these steps. I can't wait to see you there.

Life passes by in an instant, especially when we let it. Act accordingly.

— Bill



ABOUT

Bill McGlone

HEAD COACH & FOUNDER · REBOOT CAMP

I am a writer, coach and digital marketer who helps men over 40 reclaim their vitality and forge a path to the best years of their lives.

Through personal experiences, hard-earned wisdom and actionable advice collected over several years of experimentation — a fancy way of saying that I made a ton of mistakes to find out what works — I provide tools to help men find their own path to greatness in a fraction of the time it took me.

As a coach and mentor, I partner with men to help them unlock levels of joy, fulfillment and success they once believed they no longer had the time or internal fire to attain.

I live on Long Island with my wife, two golden retrievers and a revolving door of our five children who occasionally grace us with their presence at our dinner table.

REBOOT CAMP

YOUR LEGEND IS FORGED IN THE SECOND HALF.

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